

between reining in bureaucratic terrorism and harassing sincere officials under the garb of providing efficient administration ("Bullying Babudom", December 24). Her wings need to be clipped to prevent her from turning into a dictator.

ARVIND K. PANDEY, *Allahabad*

Grey Matters

Our scientists at DRDO have proved that they are second to none when it comes to brain power ("The New Shield", December 24). It will be only a matter of time when they achieve India's long-cherished ambition of indigenously-developed long range radars and faster interceptors to destroy medium range ballistic missiles that can travel more than 2,000 km.

NALINI VIJAYARAGHAVAN,
Thiruvananthapuram

Gunning for Trouble

Lack of patience among the youth and delayed justice through courts are responsible for a generation that does not shirk in picking up a gun to settle scores ("Rule of the Gun", December 17).

V.K. NAIR, *Mumbai*

Neglecting our Own

It was painful to see that the barbarity meted out to the Adivasis in Assam was tucked away in a corner of a magazine while a Bangladeshi (Taslima Nasreen) and Pakistanis (Nawaz Sharif and Benazir Bhutto) were considered important enough to be given a number of pages ("Insult to Injury", December 10).

It would be better if the magazine is christened World Today instead of INDIA TODAY.

SMITA AGARWAL, *Nagaon, Assam*

Mainstreaming Madrasas

The so-called progressive schools for Muslims is not a good idea ("Writing a New Chapter", December 10). It is better that every child undergoes similar schooling. This will help them in becoming a part of the mainstream.

NARAYANA SWAMY, *on e-mail*

There is nothing mainstream or modern about teaching a child that J stands for Jihad. The accompanying picture shows warriors crossing over a mountainous terrain resembling Kashmir. It seems that these schools, which being projected as "modern" for the secularly gullible, are actually English versions of Talibanised madrasas.

S. ARAVINDAN NEELAKANDAN,
Kanyakumari



The story on Chief Minister Narendra Modi shows that making a government responsive to the people is his priority ("The Cult of Modi", December 17). He has continued to inspire the grassroots administration by passing on the fruits of development to the common man.

VINOD C. DIXIT, *Ahmedabad*

Modi should be applauded for the manner in which he has stood his ground despite being a butt of ridicule from his opponents though it will be better if he avoids using profanities in public meetings.

ROHAN S. ANGADI, *Dharwad*

The increasing trend of global Islamic radicalism and Congress's failure to inspire confidence among people in this regard has already pushed the voters towards a leader like Modi.

K.V. RAGHURAM, *Wayanad*

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Years Ago in India Today

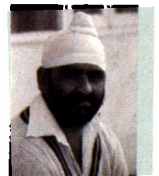
JANUARY 16-31, 1978



The Sweet Taste of Victory

And so to Adelaide... With their tails right up, Bishen Singh Bedi and his men are well on their way to glory with the scorecard in the current Indo-Australian cricket series reading two up, two down and one to go. The fifth and decisive Test begins in

Adelaide on January 28. Not surprisingly, yesterday's patronising tone



towards the Bedi Indians used by the Australian cricket writers seems to have disappeared. Before the victory at Melbourne, India had never won a Test in Australia. Now the scenario is more pleasing. Skipper Bedi—he has become quite a crowd-puller here with his colourful headgear—has stuck to his analysis that India's performance was due to a great team effort. Looking at the scorecard, it is extremely difficult to single out any one player. No other touring side has ever given such a good performance as a team.

—Girish Kumar and Khalid Anwar

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